

## Doughnuts Around the World

*Madriños* eat *churros* around the clock, but many cultures have their own love affairs with sizzling deep-fried dough. Whether they are called doughnuts, fritters, *beignets*, or *sopapillas*, they are often eaten as breakfast food or sweet treats at street fairs and markets.

### MADRID

#### Chocolatería San Ginés inexpensive

Pasadizo de San Ginés 5; +34 913 656 546

Neat rows of cups and saucers on a marble bar greet customers at this institution beloved by generations of *Madriños*. At midnight, dawn, and noon, San Ginés serves the thick chocolate and lightly crisp *churros* against which all others are judged.

#### Chocolatería Valor inexpensive

Calle Postigo de San Martín 7; [www.valor.es](http://www.valor.es)

Founded in 1881, Valor is one of Spain's most famous makers of premium chocolate, used for baking, cooking, and confectionery. The company's signature *bonbonería* (sweets and bakery store), just a few steps from Puerta del Sol, serves rich hot chocolate with unusually large, unfluted *churros*.

#### Maestro Churrero inexpensive

Calle Atocha 19; [www.maestorchurrero.com](http://www.maestorchurrero.com)

This popular *churrería* traces its roots to a rolling cart from 1902 that allowed a *Madriño* named Don Florencio to cater to theater-goers. Five generations down the line, his successors continue to warm hungry breakfast patrons and revelers needing a sweet bite after hours of tapas and drinks.

### VALENCIA, SPAIN

Deep-fried pastries are as integral to Valencian cuisine as paella. Street vendors even sell hot chocolate and pumpkin *buñuelos* (a small bun similar to a *churro*) during the March carnival of Las Fallas (the Fires).

#### Estación del Norte inexpensive

Calle Xàtiva 24

Whether travelers are arriving or departing, they can always count on a quick pick-me-up of toasty *churros* and hot chocolate from the gleaming

stainless steel outdoor kiosks that operate from dawn to midnight in front of Valencia's Art Nouveau train station in the heart of the city.

#### Horchatería El Siglo inexpensive

Plaza Santa Catalina 11; +34 963 918 466

Founded in 1836, this venerable café is celebrated for its milky *horchata* drink made from *chufa*, or tiger nuts. Cool and refreshing, it is usually served with *churros* or *buñuelos* (cheese doughnuts) – which staff often cook outdoors to attract customers, as the aromas are virtually irresistible.

#### Horchatería Santa Catalina inexpensive

Plaza Santa Catalina 6;  
[www.horchateriasantacatalina.com](http://www.horchateriasantacatalina.com)

Decorated in classic Valencian painted tiles, this rival to El Siglo is acclaimed for its hot chocolate, often ordered with *churros*. A larger sweet bread called a *farton*, which lacks the fluting of a *churro* and is sometimes glazed, usually accompanies *horchata*.

### UNITED STATES

The United States spawned the sweetened fried dough known as the doughnut – a spherical or ring-shaped variation on the *churro*. But the country's many immigrant groups have not forgotten their own ethnic variations on deep-fried sweet fritters.

#### Doughnut Plant inexpensive

379 Grand Street, New York, New York;  
[www.doughnutplant.com](http://www.doughnutplant.com)

This artisanal doughnut shop in the Lower East Side of Manhattan has become a confectionery cult, in part because it incorporates fresh seasonal fruits such as strawberries and blueberries into the glazes. Weekend lines stretch out the door.

#### Dunkin' Donuts inexpensive

543 Southern Artery, Quincy, Massachusetts;  
[www.dunkindonuts.com](http://www.dunkindonuts.com)

Dunkin' Donuts opened its first shop in Quincy, Massachusetts, in 1950, featuring fresh coffee and a doughnut with a small handle, allowing it to be dunked. The chain has since spread the American doughnut – in 52 varieties, including the perennially favorite plain, glazed, and jelly-filled types – to 31 countries around the world.

